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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 2

Semester 1

Terms 1 and 2

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This booklet belongs to

_____

Preciouslyours Pte Ltd, trading as Math Inquirers

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 2 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 1 of two booklets (Terms 1 and 2). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 2 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 1 and 2, the other booklet follows Semester 2 (Terms 3 and 4). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (9 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (9 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Letters in an order, a grid or a choice.** Each number, card, picture or choice carries a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.
- **Loop.** The numbers on touching tiles must match all the way round the loop.

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S1-11) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as stories with more than one step and families of multiplication and division facts, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of rulers, scales, clocks, coins and notes are original drawings, not to scale unless a page says so. Coins and notes are inspired by Singapore money, drawn larger than real and in black and white.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

Contents: Semester 1

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S1-01	P2-01	Hundreds, Tens, Ones	1 star
S1-03	P2-09	Words and Numbers	1 star
S1-04	P2-12	Odd or Even	1 star
S1-05	P2-10	Digit Cards	2 stars
S1-06	P2-11	Number Patterns	2 stars
S1-07	P2-17	Mystery Numbers	2 stars
S1-08	P2-02	Column Sums	1 star
S1-09	P2-03	Mental Jumps	1 star
S1-10	P2-13	Missing Digits	2 stars
S1-11	P2-18	Story Sums to 1000	2 stars
S1-12	P2-04	Equal Groups	1 star
S1-13	P2-05	Share It Out	1 star
S1-14	P2-14	Times Table Maze	1 star
S1-15	P2-19	Fact Families	2 stars
S1-16	P2-20	True or False Tables	2 stars
S1-18	P2-15	Parts of a Whole	1 star
S1-19	P2-21	Fraction Order	2 stars
S1-20	P2-22	Fraction Sums	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P2-01 to P2-40).

What the booklet covers

Whole Numbers 1.1 counting in tens/hundreds **S1-06**

Whole Numbers 1.2 number notation, representations and place values (hundreds, tens, ones) **S1-01, S1-05, S1-07**

Whole Numbers 1.3 reading and writing numbers in numerals and in words **S1-03**

Whole Numbers 1.4 comparing and ordering numbers **S1-05, S1-07**

Whole Numbers 1.5 patterns in number sequences **S1-06**

Whole Numbers 1.6 odd and even numbers **S1-04, S1-05, S1-07**

Addition and Subtraction 2.1 addition and subtraction algorithms (up to 3 digits) **S1-08, S1-10, S1-11**

Addition and Subtraction 2.2 mental calculation involving addition and subtraction of a 3-digit number and ones/tens/hundreds **S1-09, S1-11**

Multiplication and Division 3.1 multiplication tables of 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10 **S1-12, S1-14, S1-16**

Multiplication and Division 3.2 use of ÷ **S1-13, S1-14, S1-15**

Multiplication and Division 3.3 relationship between multiplication and division **S1-15, S1-16**

Multiplication and Division 3.4 multiplying and dividing within the multiplication tables **S1-12, S1-13, S1-15, S1-16**

Multiplication and Division 3.5 mental calculation involving multiplication and division within multiplication tables of 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10 **S1-14, S1-16**

Fractions 1.1 fraction as part of a whole **S1-18**

Fractions 1.2 notation and representations of fractions **S1-18, S1-19**

Fractions 1.3 comparing and ordering fractions with denominators of given fractions not exceeding 12 (unit fractions; like fractions) **S1-19**

Fractions 2.1 adding and subtracting like fractions within one whole with denominators of given fractions not exceeding 12 **S1-20**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Money 1.1; Money 1.2; Money 1.3; Money 1.4; Length, Mass and Volume 1.1; Length, Mass and Volume 1.2; Length, Mass and Volume 1.3; Time 2.1; Time 2.2; Time 2.3; 2D Shapes 1.1; 3D Shapes 2.1; Picture Graphs with Scales 1.1.

S1-01 (P2-01)

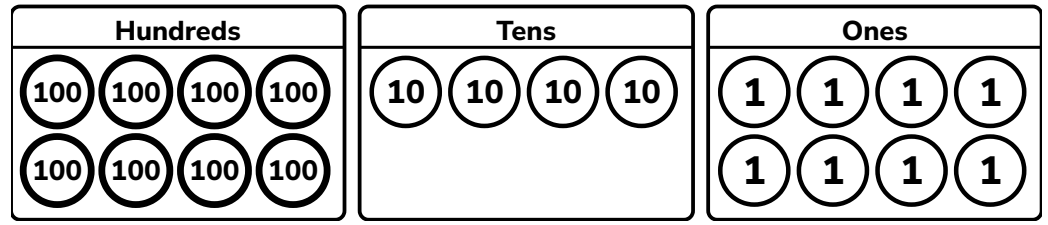
Hundreds, Tens, Ones

Name _____

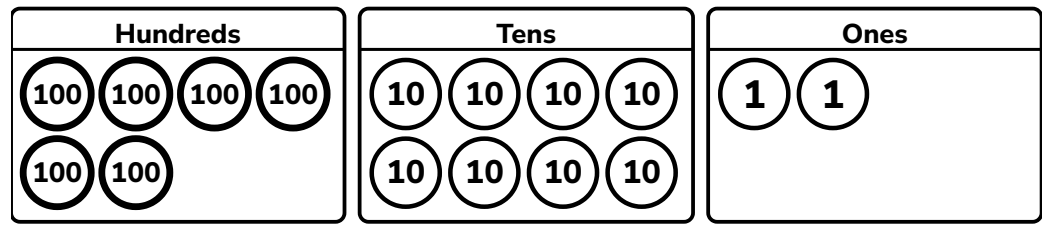
Topic: Place value: hundreds, tens and ones

Look at each item.
Write the number in the box.
Use the code table.

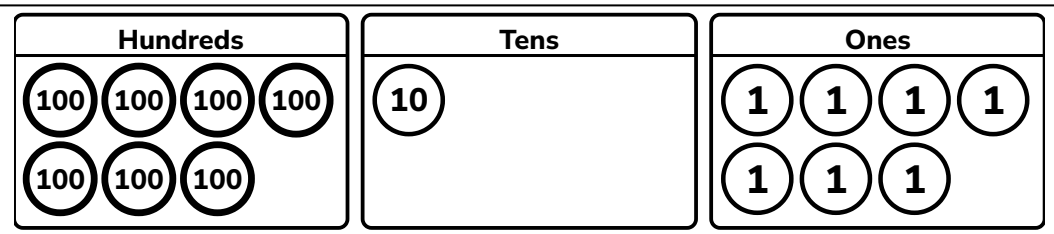
1



2



3



4 In 215, what is the value of the digit 2?

5 4 hundreds, 11 tens and 2 ones make which number?

6 7 hundreds, 0 tens and 4 ones make which number?

Code table

74 = X	200 = U	268 = N	512 = D	682 = L
704 = S	717 = O	771 = K	848 = C	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-03 (P2-09)

Words and Numbers

★ Name _____

Topic: Reading and writing numbers in words and in numerals

Start at START. Move up, down, left or right.
Go to the box with the word for your number.
The number is at the foot of the box.

seven hundred and forty-five **511**	**five hundred and forty-four** **192**	**eight hundred and eighty-three** **939**	**FINISH** **eight hundred and sixty-four** **789**
three hundred and ninety **389**	**eight hundred and eighty-three** **706**	**seven hundred and forty-six** **883**	**eight hundred and eighty-three** **864**
four hundred and sixty-four **398**	**three hundred and twenty-nine** **972**	**four hundred and fifty-four** **746**	**three hundred and nineteen** **454**
four hundred and seventy-six **870**	**START** **one hundred and forty-eight** **259**	**two hundred and fifty-nine** **538**	**five hundred and thirty-eight** **319**

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Does each top word match?

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S1-04 (P2-12)

Odd or Even

Name _____

Topic: Odd and even numbers: even numbers

Start at START. Move up, down, left or right.
Step only on EVEN numbers.
Do not step on a box twice.

208	945	509	START 454
418	308	336	748
388	435	159	362
396	FINISH 774	973	513

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Is every box even?

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S1-05 (P2-10)

Digit Cards

★★ Name _____

Topic: Numbers to 1000: make, compare and order numbers from digit cards

Use all three cards once each.
Make the number. Write it in the box.
Use the code table.

1. 5 8 2
Make the smallest odd number.
☐

2. 7 2 5
Make the second smallest number.
☐

3. 4 0 1
Make the second greatest number.
☐

4. 6 2 1
Make the greatest number.
☐

5. 1 7 8
Make the greatest even number.
☐

6. 0 5 9
Make the smallest number.
☐

Code table

275 = U	285 = C	401 = R	509 = W	527 = K
621 = F	718 = E	817 = X	825 = P	

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word?
☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S1-06 (P2-11)

Number Patterns

★★ Name _____

Topic: Number patterns: counting on and back in 2s, 3s, 4s, 5s, 10s and 100s

Find the rule. Write the missing number.
Each row counts on or back by the same amount.
Use the code table.

1	540	550	560	570		590
2	390	490	590	690		890
3	182	185	188	191		197
4	830	730		530	430	330
5	724	719	714	709		699
6	314	318	322		330	334

Code table

194 = T	326 = M	336 = R	580 = F	604 = Z
630 = H	640 = X	704 = O	790 = A	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-07 (P2-17)

Mystery Numbers

★★ Name _____

Topic: 3-digit numbers: digits, odd and even, more and less

Find each mystery number.
Write it in the box.
Use the code table.

1. My tens digit is more than my ones digit.
   My hundreds digit is 4.
   My ones digit is 8.

2. Two of my digits are the same.
   I am an even number.
   My tens digit is 8.
   My hundreds digit is 9.

3. My tens digit is 0.
   My ones digit is 2 more than my tens digit.
   I am more than 180.
   I am less than 227.

4. My ones digit is 7 more than my tens digit.
   My hundreds digit is 9.
   I am an even number.

5. My tens digit is 7.
   Two of my digits are the same.
   My ones digit is 3.
   I am more than 698.

Code table

202 = L	203 = J	498 = V	737 = X
773 = T	873 = F	918 = E	988 = A

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S1-08 (P2-02)

Column Sums

★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract in columns, 3-digit numbers

Work out each sum in columns.
Write the answer in the box.
Use the code table.

1

$$\begin{array}{r} 304 \\ +\ 219 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

2

$$\begin{array}{r} 433 \\ +\ 124 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

3

$$\begin{array}{r} 142 \\ +\ 294 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

4

$$\begin{array}{r} 722 \\ -\ 216 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

5

$$\begin{array}{r} 746 \\ -\ 594 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

6

$$\begin{array}{r} 648 \\ -\ 124 \\ \hline \square \end{array}$$

Code table

152 = T	252 = X	436 = I	506 = N	516 = U
523 = D	524 = Y	557 = A	657 = J	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-09 (P2-03)

Mental Jumps

★ Name _____

Topic: Mental sums: 3-digit numbers with ones, tens and hundreds

Start at START. Move up, down, left or right.
Step only on boxes with the answer 655.
Do not step on a box twice.

756 – 1	556 + 100	FINISH 585 + 70	254 + 400
575 + 60	695 – 40	647 + 8	625 + 30
656 – 1	642 – 7	676 – 20	255 + 400
START 455 + 200	653 + 2	855 – 200	660 – 5

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Does every box make 655?

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S1-10 (P2-13)

Missing Digits

★★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract in columns: find the missing digit

One digit is missing from each sum.
Write the missing digit in the box.
Use the code table.

1

$$\begin{array}{r} 532 \\ -\,222 \\ \hline 31\square \end{array}$$

2

$$\begin{array}{r} 604 \\ +\,\square 82 \\ \hline 986 \end{array}$$

3

$$\begin{array}{r} 892 \\ -\,1\square 3 \\ \hline 749 \end{array}$$

4

$$\begin{array}{r} 153 \\ +\,\square 14 \\ \hline 267 \end{array}$$

5

$$\begin{array}{r} 123 \\ +\,459 \\ \hline \square 82 \end{array}$$

6

$$\begin{array}{r} 493 \\ -\,204 \\ \hline \square 89 \end{array}$$

Code table

0 = C	1 = A	2 = Y	3 = R
4 = E	5 = M	6 = J	9 = L

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S1-11 (P2-18)

Story Sums to 1000

★★ Name _____

Topic: Two-step stories with numbers to 1000

Read each story.
Work out the answer in two steps.
Use the code table.

1 Jenny has 584 books.
Siti has 222.
Siti gets 182 more. How many more does Jenny have now?

2 A box has 866 beads.
237 are used on Monday.
202 are used on Tuesday.
How many are left?

3 A shop has 384 coins.
It gets 240 more on Monday.
It gets 131 more on Tuesday.
How many in all?

4 Ali has 483 pens.
Ali buys 76 more.
Then Ali gives away 38.
How many pens now?

5 Ravi has 155 marbles.
Wei has 210 more than Ravi.
How many do they have in all?

6 Tom has 253 shells.
Tom has 63 fewer than Jenny.
How many do they have in all?

Code table

180 = S	427 = P	520 = G	521 = N	569 = E
624 = K	629 = J	755 = O	765 = Z	

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S1-12 (P2-04)

Equal Groups

★ Name _____

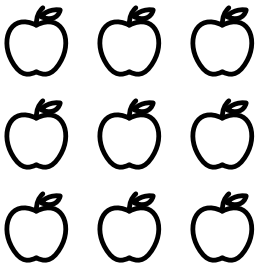
Topic: Multiplication: tables of 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10

Find how many in all.
Write the answer in the box.
Use the code table.

1 5 × ? = 35 ☐

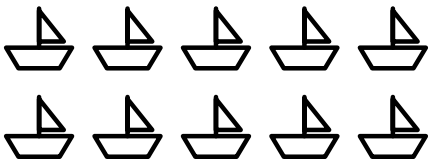
2 Jenny has 5 groups of 4 marbles. How many marbles in all? ☐

3 How many apples in all?



☐

4 How many boats in all?



☐

5 There are 3 tables. 6 children sit at each table. How many children? ☐

6 4 × 4 = ? ☐

Code table

7 = L	8 = J	9 = N	10 = G	11 = Q
15 = U	16 = H	18 = T	20 = E	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S1-13 (P2-05)

Share It Out

★ Name _____

Topic: Division: sharing and grouping, the sign ÷

Share or group. Find each answer.
Write the answer in the box.
Use the code table.

1 6 ÷ 2 = ?

2 32 ÷ 4 = ?

3 How many 3s are in 12?

4 12 marbles are shared equally among 2 children. How many does each child get?

5 70 eggs are put in boxes of 10. How many boxes are needed?

6 Kumar shares 27 grapes equally with 2 friends. How many does each person get?

Code table

2 = Q	3 = N	4 = M	6 = B	7 = E
8 = U	9 = R	10 = X	13 = P	24 = J

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-14 (P2-14)

Times Table Maze

★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication and division facts: tables of 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10

Start at START. Move up, down, left or right.
Step only on boxes with the answer 10.
Do not step on a box twice.

2 × 2	30 ÷ 3	START 1 × 10	20 ÷ 2
4 × 3	2 × 7	6 × 2	2 × 5
45 ÷ 5	10 × 1	100 ÷ 10	40 ÷ 4
18 ÷ 2	FINISH 50 ÷ 5	24 ÷ 3	5 × 2

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 7? Does every box make 10?

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S1-15 (P2-19)

Fact Families

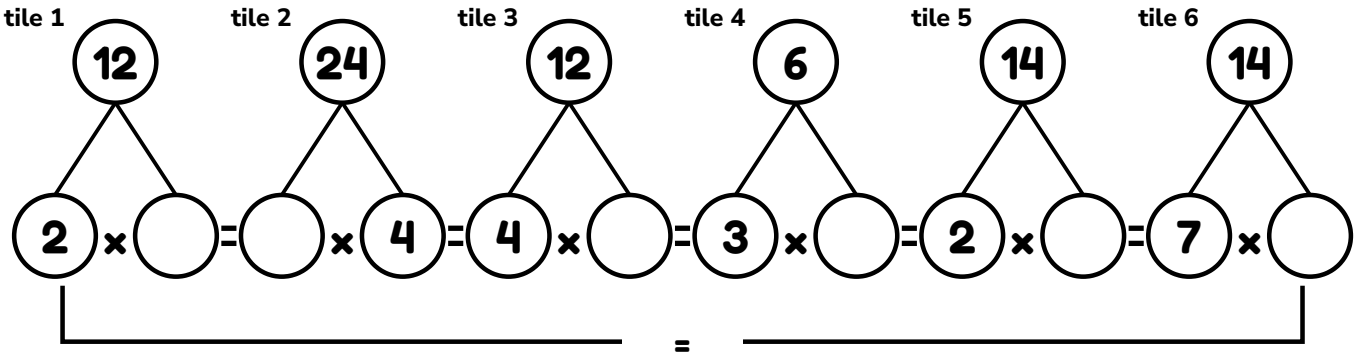
★★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication and division: finding the missing number, the loop that closes

Find the number in each empty circle.
Touching circles joined by = match.
Go round the loop.

Example
Top 12. Left 3. Right?
12 ÷ 3 = 4. Check: 3 × 4 = 12.

Each tile: top = left × right.



Write the numbers for the empty circles, tile 1 to tile 6.

tile 1	tile 2	tile 3	tile 4	tile 5	tile 6

Check it. Go round the loop. Do the numbers joined by = match?

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S1-16 (P2-20)

True or False Tables ★★

Name _____

Topic: Multiplication and division facts: true or false

Is each statement true or false?
Circle the letter of the right choice.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

(1) $4 \times 5 = 20$ — **T** (W) **F** (E)

(2) 10 groups of 8 is 80. — **T** (A) **F** (I)

(3) $36 \div 4 = 11$ — **T** (J) **F** (L)

(4) If $3 \times 9 = 27$, then $27 \div 9 = 2$. — **T** (V) **F** (N)

(5) $5 \times 6 = 30$ — **T** (U) **F** (R)

(6) 17 is in the 4 times table. — **T** (X) **F** (T)

Check it. Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-18 (P2-15)

Parts of a Whole

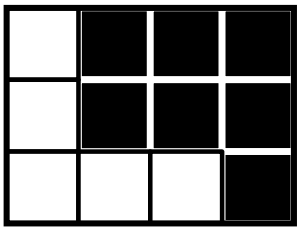
★ Name _____

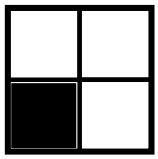
Topic: Fractions: parts of a whole, shaded parts

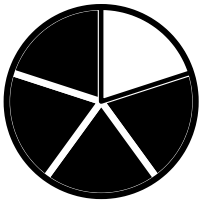
Each shape has equal parts.
Write the shaded part as a fraction.
Use the code table.

1  $\square$ / $\square$

2  $\square$ / $\square$

3  $\square$ / $\square$

4  $\square$ / $\square$

5  $\square$ / $\square$

6  $\square$ / $\square$

Code table

$\frac{1}{3}$ = B	$\frac{1}{4}$ = Z	$\frac{1}{5}$ = N	$\frac{1}{12}$ = F	$\frac{2}{3}$ = R
$\frac{2}{5}$ = X	$\frac{4}{5}$ = E	$\frac{6}{12}$ = K	$\frac{7}{11}$ = Q	$\frac{7}{12}$ = O

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word? $\square$ $\square$ $\square$ $\square$ $\square$ $\square$

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S1-19 (P2-21)

Fraction Order

★★ Name _____

Topic: Fractions: comparing and ordering like fractions and unit fractions

Put each set of fractions in order.
Write the letter of each card in its place.
Set A: like fractions. Set B: unit fractions.

Set A: smallest first.

$\frac{3}{9}$	$\frac{5}{9}$	$\frac{8}{9}$
B	A	N

Set B: greatest first.

$\frac{1}{5}$	$\frac{1}{6}$	$\frac{1}{2}$
I	T	D

Write the letters in order: Set A, then Set B.

Check it. Read the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S1-20 (P2-22)

Fraction Sums

★★ Name _____

Topic: Fractions: adding and subtracting like fractions within one whole

Add or subtract the fractions.
Write the top number in the box.
Use the code table.

1 $\frac{2}{6} - \frac{1}{6} = \frac{\square}{6}$

2 $\frac{2}{5} + \frac{2}{5} = \frac{\square}{5}$

3 $1 - \frac{1}{12} = \frac{\square}{12}$

4 Hana ate $\frac{4}{12}$ of a cake. Siti ate $\frac{5}{12}$. What fraction did they eat in all?

$\frac{\square}{12}$

5 $\frac{5}{8} + \frac{\square}{8} = 1$ whole

6 $\frac{8}{12} - \frac{1}{12} = \frac{\square}{12}$

Code table

1 = A	2 = G	3 = E	4 = N	5 = J
6 = Z	7 = R	9 = W	11 = S	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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